PTA
Parent Teacher Association

ARENA SCHOOL

PTA PARENT COFFEE · OCTOBER 14, 2026

Our Kids' Jobs *Don't Exist Yet.*

So Which Skills Will Matter?

From what's changing at work *to what you can do at home.*

1

Work is being rewritten

Even in the safest careers

2

Three skills decide who gets ahead

Agency, taste, and craft

3

What families can do now

Three takeaways

We trained at ISB, Caltech, Harvard, Brown, and Tsinghua, then did *the jobs AI is now automating.*



Jing Jing Yang

ISB Class of 2019

STUDIED — INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED — Deloitte. · CICC 中金公司

NOW — Advises Chinese AI firms on going global

KIMI



Phillip An

Forbes 30 Under 30

Y Combinator alum

STUDIED — Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED — Goldman Sachs · McKinsey&Company

NOW — Co-founder & CEO, Skylarq

AI agents for sales

THE QUESTION BEHIND TODAY'S TALK

When AI can draft an essay in seconds, what must our children *still learn to do?*

SECTION 1

AI is already changing work in China and around the world, *including the careers families trust most.*

1 Work is being rewritten
Even in the safest careers

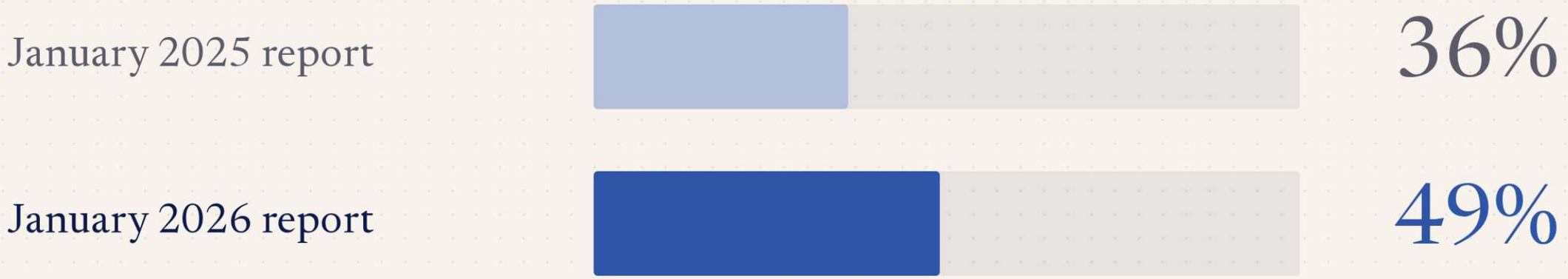
2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
Agency, taste, and craft

3 What families can do now
Three takeaways

In about half of all jobs, AI is already used for *at least a quarter of the tasks.*

ANTHROP\C

Occupations where AI is used in at least a quarter of tasks



Anthropic Economic Index, Jan 15, 2026: share of occupations using AI for at least 25% of their tasks (36% in the January 2025 report). The 2026 figure pools data across reports and reflects how people use Claude, not a census of every worker.

And in China it is already in children's hands: 602 million users, *the largest group 19 or younger.*

CHINA INTERNET NETWORK INFORMATION CENTER

602 million

generative AI users in China, December 2025



26.4% aged 19 and under, the largest group

73.6% all other ages

CNNIC, 57th Statistical Report on China's Internet Development, Feb 5, 2026, data as of December 2025

THE CAREERS PARENTS HOPE FOR

The safest careers are *changing too.*

1

Doctors

A randomized trial in China

2

Lawyers

A US trial, and China

3

Bankers

China's biggest bank

4

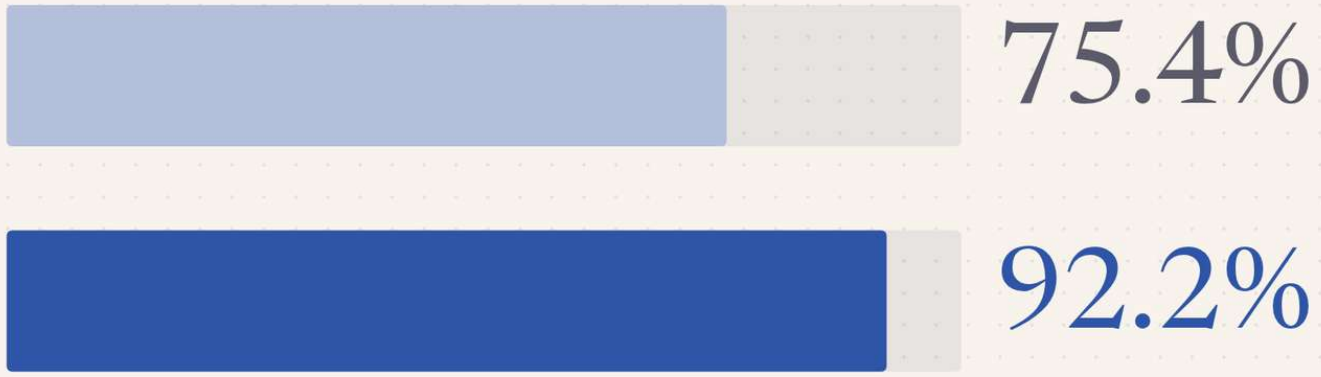
Engineers

Salesforce and Google

In a randomized trial, eye doctors working with AI got the diagnosis right *92% of the time. Without AI, 75%.*

THE EYEFM TRIAL · NATURE MEDICINE

Patients given the correct diagnosis



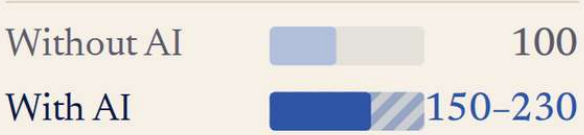
Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Tsinghua University, and others, Nature Medicine, Aug 28, 2025: 668 patients and 16 eye doctors at one centre, retinal screening; correct referrals also rose, from 80.5% to 92.2%

Law students using AI got *50% to 130% more done* on most legal tasks.

A RANDOMIZED TRIAL IN THE US

+50–130%

more work done with AI, on 5 of 6 legal tasks



LAWYERS IN MAINLAND CHINA

93%

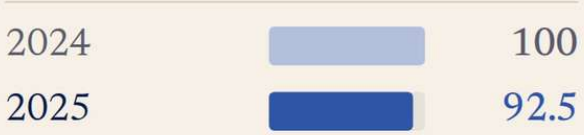
of lawyers and trainees already use AI at work



LARGE US LAW FIRMS

−7.5%

new-graduate lawyers hired in 2025, the first drop since 2014



Schwarcz, Manning, Prescott, and others, "AI-Powered Lawyering", 137 law students, 2026; LexisNexis survey of 404 legal professionals in mainland China, via Caixin, Aug 29, 2025; NALP, Class of 2025, Aug 5, 2026, which does not attribute the drop to AI alone

At ICBC, China's biggest bank, AI did work equal to *about 13% of its staff* in 2025.

55,000 person-years

ICBC

of work done by AI "digital employees", at a bank with 409,758 staff

7,800 roles

standard chartered

in corporate functions to go by 2030, replacing what its CEO called "lower-value human capital."

ICBC 2025 Annual Report, March 27, 2026 (13% is our calculation); Standard Chartered investor event, May 19, 2026: 15% of corporate-function roles; Bill Winters later apologised for the wording

Salesforce has stopped growing its engineering team. Its CEO says *AI is the reason.*

"We've been using AI to create more efficiencies for our engineers ... we're not hiring more engineers."

Marc Benioff, CEO of Salesforce, earnings call, May 27, 2026

75%

Google

of new code at Google is written by AI and approved by engineers

10×

CHINA'S BIG TECH FIRMS

the demand for AI roles, while hiring for basic coding jobs has fallen sharply

Fortune and Yahoo Finance on the Salesforce call, May 27–28, 2026; Sundar Pichai, Google Cloud Next, April 22, 2026; 界面新闻 citing Maimai (脉脉), August 2025

Companies are already acting. Amazon has cut *about 30,000 corporate jobs.*

amazon

JUNE 17, 2025

The CEO's memo

AI "will reduce our total corporate workforce"

OCTOBER 28, 2025

14,000

corporate roles cut

JANUARY 28, 2026

16,000

more corporate roles cut

Amazon: Andy Jassy memo, June 17, 2025; workforce memos, Oct 28, 2025 and Jan 28, 2026. Amazon also cited cutting layers of management, and Jassy later said the October cuts were "not even really AI-driven."

“Those who embrace this change, become conversant in AI … will be well-positioned to *have high impact.*”

amazon

Andy Jassy, CEO of Amazon

Memo to employees, June 17, 2025

WHAT THE SKILLS ARE WORTH · PWC 2026 GLOBAL AI JOBS BAROMETER

The pay gap is already here: jobs that require AI skills pay *62% more.*

62%

PWC

higher advertised pay for jobs that require AI skills



PwC 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer, June 15, 2026: average wage premium in job ads across 27 countries; it does not control for education or experience

Young people feel it first: in the most exposed jobs they are already *19% behind.*

AGES 22 TO 25

−19%

employment in AI-exposed jobs, against peers their age in less-exposed jobs

EXPERIENCED WORKERS

No gap

in the same AI-exposed jobs

Brynjolfsson, Chandar, and Chen, “Canaries in the Coal Mine?”, revised August 2026; descriptive, not a causal estimate

In China, 81% of students say AI skills make them more competitive, yet *40% of them haven't started.*

MYCOS 麦可思

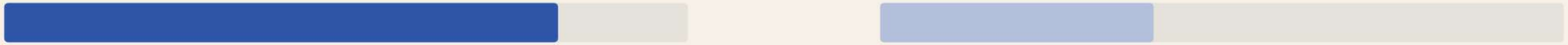
SAY AI SKILLS MAKE THEM MORE COMPETITIVE

81%

YET

OF THOSE, HAVEN'T STARTED LEARNING YET

40%



MyCOS online survey, March 19–20, 2026, published April 16, 2026

SECTION 2

So three skills now decide who gets ahead: *agency, taste, and craft.*

1 Work is being rewritten
Even in the safest careers

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
Agency, taste, and craft

3 What families can do now
Three takeaways

Employers are already asking: entry-level jobs requiring AI skills jumped *to 35% in six months.*

US EMPLOYERS SURVEYED BY NACE

Entry-level jobs that require AI skills

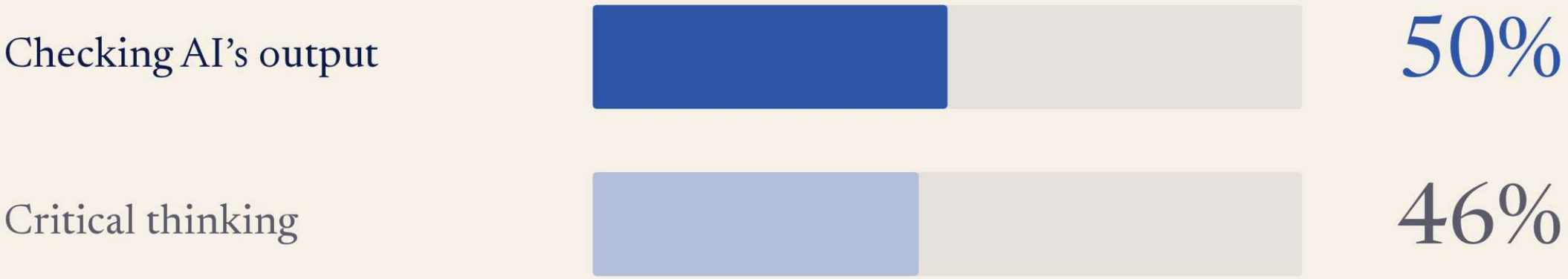


NACE Job Outlook 2026, Nov 2025; Spring Update, April 20, 2026

People who use AI at work rank one skill first: *checking what AI produces.*

Microsoft

The skills people who use AI at work rank most important



Microsoft 2026 Work Trend Index, survey fielded Feb 18 to April 7, 2026

Employers in China ask most for data skills, then AI tools and *critical thinking.*

1



Data skills

2



AI tools

3



Critical thinking

解放日报, via 上观新闻, citing 智联招聘, March 27, 2026

Everything so far points to three skills: *agency*, *taste*, and *craft*.

01

Agency

Choosing what's worth solving

Deciding what to make before anyone asks

02

Taste

Telling which version actually works

Checking AI's work before anyone relies on it

03

Craft

Finishing it well

Turning a first draft into something people trust

But most children already use AI for homework. *Most parents don't realize it.*

STUDENTS WHO HAVE USED AI FOR HOMEWORK

85.6%

BUT

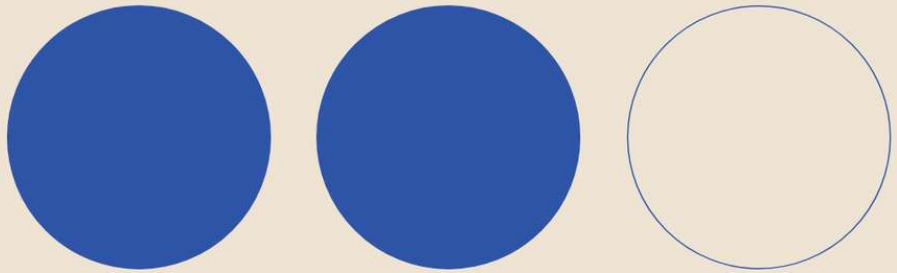
PARENTS WHO THINK STUDENTS COMMONLY DO

17.8%



China National Academy of Educational Sciences, summer 2025, via People's Daily, Aug 17, 2026. Only 13.8% of teachers thought the same

Two in three families have *no rules at all* for how their children use AI.

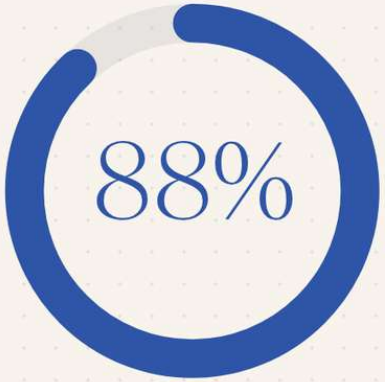


67.9%

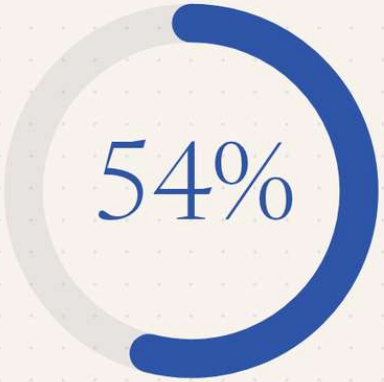
of families set no rules for their children's AI use

中国青少年研究中心 survey of 8,563 students in seven provinces, 2025, reported by People's Daily, Aug 17, 2026

Schools are moving, but most are still short of teachers *ready to teach AI.*



of schools have too few teachers ready to teach AI



of teachers lack confidence in teaching AI

CNAES survey, 3,653 responses across eastern, central, and western China, May–June 2026, published Aug 19, 2026. In the US, 68% of teachers had no school or district training on AI (Gallup and Walton Family Foundation, 2025).

The same AI can hand a child the answer or help them understand it. *Habits decide which.*

SHORTCUT

“Just give me the answer.”

The homework gets done. The thinking gets skipped.

TUTOR

“Explain it until I get it.”

The child does the thinking. AI explains and checks.

OECD, PISA 2025 results, Sept 8, 2026: students who used AI chatbots for schoolwork scored lower on average, but frequent users who had been taught to judge AI output did better. A correlation, not proof of cause

WHAT CHILDREN NEED

Skills grow from practice *with structure.*



A real project

with something at stake



A coach

who asks how you checked it



Honest feedback

from real people

SECTION 3

So start building these skills now, *while the gap is still small.*

1 Work is being rewritten
Even in the safest careers

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
Agency, taste, and craft

3 What families can do now
Three takeaways

Takeaway

1

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

Know the latest AI tools, *so you can guide your child.*

1 Know the tools | 2 Use AI for real tasks | 3 The best time to build

New agents keep arriving. A year ago most of these did not exist. *How many have you heard of?*



Kimi ●

Makes websites, slides, and reports



Muse

Meta's agent for email and travel



Instinct

Text it, and it runs your errands



Manus

Finishes many-step tasks on its own



Genspark

An all-in-one AI workspace



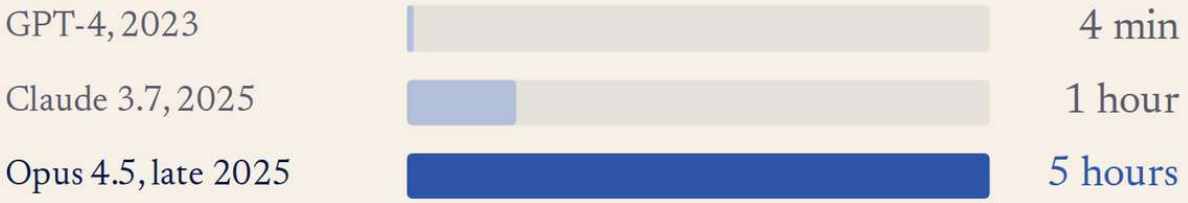
OpenClaw ●

Runs your computer, open source

The work AI can finish alone has doubled about every 7 months. *So children must keep using the tools.*

METR · 50% TIME HORIZON

Length of work a frontier model can finish on its own



2023
Cursor
an AI code editor launches

JUNE 2024
Kling
Kuaishou's AI video

MARCH 2025
Manus
an agent that finishes many-step tasks

SEPT 2026
Muse
Meta's agent for email and travel

METR, Time Horizon 1.1, Jan 29, 2026: doubled about every 7 months; GPT-4 ~4 min, Claude 3.7 ~1 hour, Opus 4.5 ~5 hours. Cursor 2023; Kling June 2024; Manus March 2025; Muse Sept 2026

Takeaway

2

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

Use AI on real tasks with real stakes, *like a school project or a job application.*

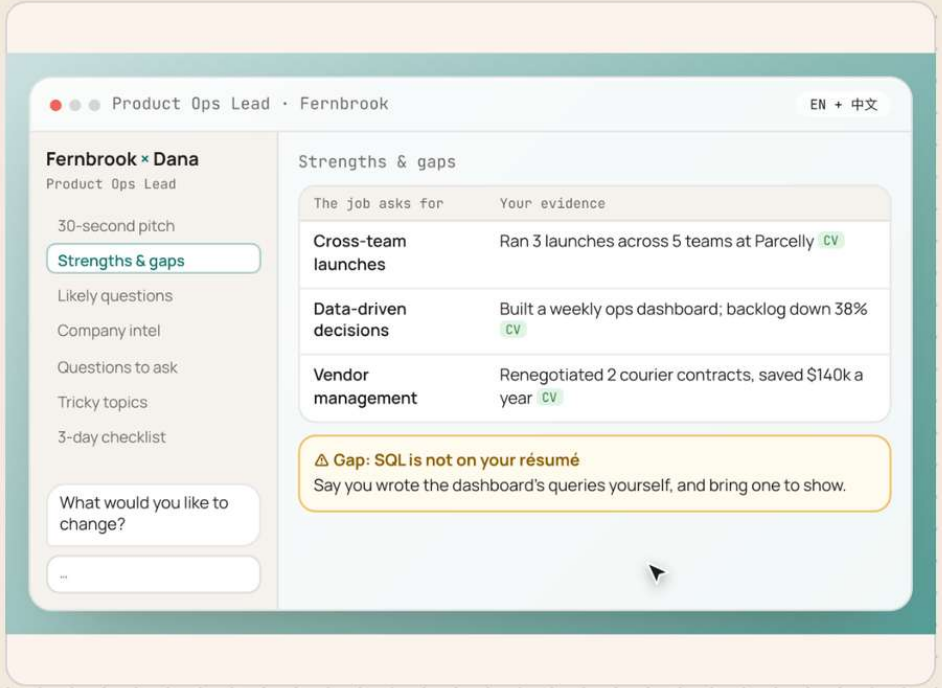
1 Know the tools | *2* Use AI for real tasks | *3* The best time to build

At Kimi, the candidate who built something before the interview *got the offer.*

KIMI

When Jing Jing was hiring for Kimi's growth team, one candidate built a small tool for the team's social media work before the interview, showed it live, and got the offer.

Nobody asked for it. That was the point.



A first-hand hiring story from Kimi (Moonshot AI), told by Jing Jing Yang, who was hiring for Kimi's growth team. Visual: Arena Interview Prep Kit, the walkthrough used in the original deck

Takeaway

3

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

Despite all this, it's one of the best times ever to be a kid, *and the best time to build.*

1 Know the tools | 2 Use AI for real tasks | 3 The best time to build

When we were young, most ideas stayed in a notebook. Today a child can use AI to *turn one into something real.*

WHEN WE WERE YOUNG

Almost everything was done by hand

Software took a team and years

Only the family saw what you made

TODAY

AI helps build a first version quickly

Real people can try it the same week

Real users, before they leave school

Four friends who met at MIT started Cursor in 2022. Four years later, SpaceX bought it for *$60 billion in stock.*

SPACEX

2022

Four MIT friends

start a company to build an AI coding tool

2023

Cursor launches

an AI code editor for software engineers

NOVEMBER 2025

$29.3 billion

post-money valuation, with more than $1 billion in annualized revenue

AUGUST 2026

$60 billion

SpaceX completes its all-stock acquisition

Cursor, Series D post, Nov 13, 2025; Reuters, CNBC, and Bloomberg, June 16, 2026; SpaceX Form 8-K and PitchBook, Aug 14, 2026

Making is no longer the hard part. The advantage is *problem, build, feedback, and launch.*

01 Problem

02 Build

03 Real-user feedback

04 Launch



PROBLEM

Games built to publish on Steam

At ISB, 2026



BUILD

A tool that tracks progress, sleep, and working time

At ISB, 2026



FEEDBACK · LAUNCH

A sign-language interpreter, in testing

Real users, before they leave school

Work is changing faster, so children must learn *the skills that still matter.*

1

Work is changing faster

AI is already in about half of jobs, and in children's hands

2

Average is not safe

Young people already start behind, and many have not begun

3

What they must learn now

Agency, taste, and craft: choose, judge, and finish

When AI can make almost anything, students need to know what's worth making, whether it's good, and how to finish it.

Thank you. *Happy to take your questions.*

TODAY'S SLIDES

arenaschool.org/talk

TODAY'S SLIDES

arenaschool.org/talk

A PDF in English and Chinese, or read it on your phone.

TOOLS FROM THE PROGRAMS

arenaschool.org/case-study-examples

Step-by-step walkthroughs to open on your own time.

Questions after today? contact@arenaschool.org

Every figure in this talk comes from a *public 2025 or 2026 source.*

Anthropic, Economic Index: occupations using AI for at least 25% of tasks, 36% to 49%	*Jan 15, 2026*
CNNIC, 57th Statistical Report on China's Internet Development: 602 million generative AI users	*Feb 5, 2026*
Nature Medicine, the EyeFM randomized trial: 92.2% against 75.4%	*Aug 28, 2025*
Schwarcz, Manning, Prescott, and others, "AI-Powered Lawyering": 50% to 130%	*2026*
Caixin on the LexisNexis survey (93%); **NALP**, Class of 2025 (–7.5%)	*Aug 29, 2025 · Aug 5, 2026*
ICBC 2025 Annual Report: 55,000 person-years, 409,758 staff	*March 27, 2026*
Standard Chartered investor event; **The Guardian** on Bill Winters	*May 19 and 22, 2026*
Fortune and **Yahoo Finance** on Salesforce; **Google**, Sundar Pichai (75%); **SignalFire**, State of Talent	*May 2025 · April–May 2026*
界面新闻 citing 脉脉 on AI roles and basic developer hiring	*August 2025*
Business Insider on David Solomon, Goldman Sachs, at the Cisco AI Summit	*Jan 17, 2025*
Amazon: Andy Jassy memo; workforce memos (14,000 and 16,000 roles)	*June 2025–Jan 2026*
CNBC on Salesforce support (9,000 to about 5,000); **CNN** on Block	*Sept 2, 2025 · Feb 26, 2026*
Accenture Q4 fiscal 2025 earnings call; **Irish Times** on headcount	*Sept 25–26, 2025*
Business Insider on Julia Liuson's Microsoft email; **The Verge** on Duolingo's memo	*June 27, 2025 · April 28, 2025*
PwC, 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer: 62% wage premium	*June 15, 2026*
Stanford Digital Economy Lab, "Canaries in the Coal Mine?", revised	*August 2026*
MyCOS 麦可思 survey of 3,794 university students, via 未来网	*April 16, 2026*

Where the figures on skills, schools, and tools *come from.*

NACE, Job Outlook 2026 (13.3%) and Spring Update (35%)	*Nov 2025 · April 20, 2026*
Microsoft, 2026 Work Trend Index: checking AI's output (50%), critical thinking (46%)	*Feb 18–April 7, 2026*
解放日报, via 上观新闻, citing 智联招聘 on employer skills	*March 27, 2026*
央广网 on BOSS直聘 AI job postings (+74.1% in 2025)	*Jan 23, 2026*
People's Daily on 中国教育科学研究院 (85.6%, 17.8%, 13.8%) and 中国青少年研究中心 (67.9%)	*Aug 17, 2026*
北京市教育委员会, work plan for AI education (2025–2027), 京教办〔2025〕2号	*March 6, 2025*
中国教育科学研究院 survey of schools and teachers (88%, 54%); **Gallup** and **Walton Family Foundation** (68%)	*Aug 19, 2026 · 2025*
中国教育新闻网 on the teacher survey by 中国教育发展战略学会 and 学科网 (n=68,792)	*Oct 20, 2025*
METR, Time Horizon 1.1: 50% time horizon doubled about every 7 months; GPT-4 ~4 min, Claude 3.7 ~1 hour, Opus 4.5 ~5 hours	*Jan 29, 2026*
AI tools: Meta newsroom (Muse); TechCrunch (Instinct); Reuters (OpenClaw); manus.im, kimi.com, and each tool's own site	*2026 · checked Oct 11*
Kimi (Moonshot AI) hiring story, first-hand	*2026*
OECD, PISA 2025 results	*Sept 8, 2026*
Cursor: Series D post; Reuters, CNBC, and Bloomberg on SpaceX; SpaceX Form 8-K and PitchBook on the close	*Nov 2025 · June–Aug 2026*